

ADELAIDE ANNEXES & CANVAS

Lift Blanket Generator — Quick Start Guide

CanvasCovers add-in for DraftSight · v1.7.0

This add-in turns your paper lift-blanket measurement sheet into a cutter-ready DXF. You type the measurements into a form laid out like the sheet, click **Generate**, and it draws the cut piece, the COP cut-out, the quilting lines, and the dimensions on the correct cutter layers.

1. Install & turn it on (one-time)

1. Close DraftSight.
2. Run `BesiaCAD-CanvasCovers-Setup-1.7.0.exe` and approve the Windows admin prompt.
3. Open DraftSight, go to **Tools** → **Add-Ins**, and tick **CanvasCovers**. (Leave "Start Up" unticked.) You only do this once per DraftSight session.
4. A **CanvasCovers** tab appears on the ribbon with a **Canvas Covers** button.

2. Make a drawing

1. **Open or start a drawing first** (the tool draws into the active drawing).
2. Click ribbon → **CanvasCovers** → **Canvas Covers**, then pick the **Lift Blanket** tile.
3. Fill in the form (next section), then click **Generate Drawing**.
4. The view zooms out automatically so the whole drawing (notes included) is visible — no manual zooming needed.
5. If you ticked the export option, a **Save-As** box appears to save the DXF (it pre-fills the file name with the blanket text).

Undo: one press of **Ctrl+Z** removes the entire generated drawing, so it's safe to generate, look, tweak, and re-generate.

3. Filling in the form

Repeating a job

After every drawing you generate, CanvasCovers remembers what you typed. For a batch of identical blankets, click **Load Previous Job's Measurements** (top of the form) to bring back all the walls and options **and the project notes** — company, initials, project name and date. Just update the order number and network number for the new job, then click Generate.

Project information

Company, Company Initials, AAC Order Number, Network Number, Project, and Date. The **AAC Order Number + Company Initials + Network Number** become the DXF file name and the printed label on each wall, so fill them in.

Company Name is a drop-down of your regular customers; picking one fills in the initials automatically. You can still type any new name by hand. To add or change customers, edit this file in Notepad:

```
%AppData%\BesiaCAD\CanvasCovers\customers.csv
```

(Paste that into the File Explorer address bar.) One customer per line, as `Company Name, INITIALS` . Save the file, then close and reopen the CanvasCovers form — no DraftSight restart needed.

Your customer list and the previous-job memory live in that `%AppData%` folder, so they **survive updates and uninstalls** of CanvasCovers.

Options

Option	What it does
Through Car	Omits the rear wall (disables the Rear tab).
Plastic Cover on COP	Noted on the drawing's info panel.
Storage bag required	Adds a vertical BAG reminder inside the COP cutout.
Glass behind	Adds a vertical GLASS BEHIND reminder inside the COP cutout.
Fixings	Starts empty on purpose — the form won't generate until you choose, so a forgotten fixing can't slip onto a drawing. The two eyelet sizes (TG7 and TG9) are listed separately because the chosen size prints on the COP. Picking a fixing auto-fills the Fixing Allowance below.
Fixing Allowance (mm)	Subtracted from the measured height before doubling. Auto-set by the fixing type; editable if a job differs.
Quilt Inset (mm)	How far the quilting sits in from the outline so the pen clears the cut edge. The outline is always the entered size.
Quilting Spacing (mm)	Target gap between quilt lines. The tool evens it out so the lines divide cleanly.
Draw quilting lines	Turn the quilting on or off.
Open DXF export...	Pops the Save-As box after generating.

Wall tabs — Left / Right / Rear

One tab per wall. Each tab shows a diagram of the blanket with the input boxes where the measurements sit on your paper sheet. **The diagram is just a guide — it doesn't change shape as you type.** The **Right** wall is shown mirrored from the Left, the way the two walls face each other on the sheet.

Field	What to type
DR-L / DR-R	The door-return tabs at the two outer corners. Put 0 if not needed.
Total width	Optional. If filled in, it overrides the five segment boxes for the cut width. The segment boxes can still be used to place the COP.
S1	The gap from the door-return line across to the COP.
COP W (S2)	The width of the COP cut-out (the middle bottom-row box). This is the COP width — you don't type a separate COP width.

S3	The gap from the COP across to the other door-return line.
Height	The measured height (top of hook / centre of press-stud down to the bottom of the blanket). The tool subtracts the fixing allowance and doubles it for the cut — you type the plain measured number.
COP H	The height of the COP cut-out.
From bottom	The gap from the blanket bottom up to the bottom of the COP.

The **top gap** (from the top of the COP up to the fold line) is worked out for you and shown next to the COP. It turns **red** if your COP would cross the fold line — fix the COP height or "from bottom" until it goes back to normal.

If a wall has no COP, untick **Include COP cutout** on that tab. If you're not doing a wall at all, untick **Include this wall**.

Layers

The six cutter layers are listed with their colours and which job each one does (Cut / COP / Annotation / Title). The defaults already match your machine — just click **Reset to Defaults** if anything gets changed by accident:

Layer	Colour	Used for
1 Rotary Blade	 Blue	The cut outline (the part that gets cut)
5 Draw and Text	 Magenta	COP + quilt lines + wall labels (drawn/scored, not cut)
0	☐ White	Dimensions + the project info text

All six layers (0, the four blade layers, and 5 Draw and Text) are created in every DXF so the file is always complete.

4. If the form won't generate

The tool checks your entries and shows a red message listing **everything** that needs fixing, e.g.:

- A box left blank or with letters in it.
- A measured height that isn't bigger than the fixing allowance.
- A COP that would run past the edge or cross the fold line.
- No walls ticked, or a layer job not assigned.

Fix the listed items and click Generate again — your entries stay put.

If a drawing looks incomplete the tool will tell you "some entities could not be drawn." If that happens, Undo (Ctrl+Z) and generate again. If it keeps happening on the same job, send us the job details.

5. What we'd love feedback on

- Do the **cut pieces** and **COP cut-outs** come out the right size and in the right place vs. your usual DXFs?
- Is the **quilting** right — line spacing, how far in from the edges, where the vertical lines sit?
- Does **Load Previous Job's Measurements** cover your repeat-blanket batches the way you wanted?
- Is the **customer drop-down** complete, and are the initials right?
- Anything on the form that's confusing or in the wrong spot?